

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 3
 ♥ 8 2
 ♦ 10 8 2
 ♣ A K J 10 8

♠ A J 10 7 4

♥ K 10 7

♦ A 9 5

♣ 7 2



♠ K Q 2

♥ J 6 4

♦ J 7 4

♣ 6 5 4 3

♠ 6 5

♥ A Q 9 5 3

♦ K Q 6 3

♣ Q 9

West	North	East	South
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
Lead: ♣K			

What do you open with this hand? You opens 1 ♠ and South, responds 2 ♥. Note that this promises a 5-card or longer ♥ suit. (2 of a minor only promises 4+). What do you rebid? Knowing that South has 5, you bid 3 ♥ to confirm the trump suit. South bids 4 ♥.

South went straight to game, showing a minimum opener and no slam interest. You are also satisfied to just play at game. 2/1 is a good bidding method, and here, 4 ♥ is a good contract. But you can see that it is not a laydown - there is no bidding system that will always reach 100% contracts. In this hand a 3-3 ♦ split will provide the 10th trick, or if that fails, taking 2 ♠ finesses provides a 75% chance of success.

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 10 8

♥ J 4

♦ A 10 9 8 5 3

♣ 7 4

♠ 7

♥ A K 7 5

♦ K 7 6 2

♣ K Q 10 6



♠ Q 4 3

♥ Q 6 2

♦ Q J

♣ J 9 5 3 2

♠ A K 9 6 5 2

♥ 10 9 8 3

♦ 4

♣ A 8

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♥

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

Lead: ♣7

South opens 1♠. You have 15 HCP, but you only have 4♥s, so you can't bid 2♥ (this would promise a 5-card suit). So instead you bid clubs. This is natural and game-forcing, but only promises 4+ clubs. Note that holding two 4-card minors you bid them up-the-line, just as in standard bidding. South rebids 2♥. This shows at least 4 hearts. What do you rebid now? Your 3♥ bid confirms hearts as trump. There's no worry partner might pass - we are in a game forcing auction. South raises to 4♥, showing no slam interest.

We don't have enough for slam opposite a minimum opener, so we just pass. Note South's decision to show the poor 4-card heart suit for their second bid, instead of showing the 6th spade. In a GF sequence, it's more important to tell about 4 more cards than 1 more card. South will always have the chance to rebid spades later if there is no heart fit.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 6 4

♥ 7 5

♦ 6 3

♣ A Q 10 4 3 2

♠ 8 7 5

♥ K 4

♦ A Q J 10 7

♣ K 9 7



♠ Q 10 3

♥ J 10 6 2

♦ K 9 4 2

♣ J 5

♠ A K 9 2

♥ A Q 9 8 3

♦ 8 5

♣ 8 6

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
Lead: ♣J			

South opens 1♥ - how do you respond? South next bids 2♠, showing the other Major suit. In standard bidding this is a Reverse, showing a strong hand with 5♥s and 4♠s. But after a 2/1 GF response, South doesn't need extra values to show their 4-card spade suit. What should you rebid? You assume South to be 4-5 in the Majors, and since you can't support either one, you bid 2NT. If South actually has 6♥s (or 5♠s) he would rebid the suit. Your 2NT bid guarantees a stopper in the fourth suit.

South does not have either 6♥s or 5♠s so he just bids 3NT. Notice that South never once considered the possibility of passing what might be a misfit - the initial 2/1 response unconditionally forced the partnership to reach a game somewhere.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 5 3
♥ Q 5 4
♦ A Q 4 2
♣ 10 4 3

♠ K 8

♥ J 10 7

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A K J 6 2



♠ Q J 6

♥ K 6 2

♦ J 10 8 3

♣ 9 8 5

♠ A 9 7 4 2

♥ A 9 8 3

♦ K 6

♣ Q 7

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♦ ¹	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
1. 4th suit			

Lead: ♦ 2

South opens 1 ♠ - how do you respond? With 13 points, you respond 2 ♣, a natural 2/1 force to game. South next bids 2 ♥, showing the other Major suit. What do you rebid now? You assume South to be 5-4 in the Majors, so you cannot support either. You cannot bid 2NT without a stopper in ♦ s. So you bid the fourth suit, 3 ♦, telling South you know you must make a bid, but can't find anything appropriate. This is an artificial bid, and normally denies a diamond stopper (otherwise you would have bid 2NT). South rebids 3NT - what do you do now?

South now must find a bid. His choices include rebidding the 5-card ♠ s, supporting North's ♣ s with a doubleton Queen, or bidding 3NT with the ♦ K 6 as a stopper. He chooses this last option. It appears that 3NT is the best game for these two hands.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 8 2

♥ 9

♦ 10 8 7 5

♣ K 5 4 2

♠ K J 7 6 3

♥ A Q 7

♦ J 4

♣ A Q J



♠ Q 5

♥ 4 2

♦ A 9 6 3 2

♣ 10 9 6 3

♠ A 4

♥ K J 10 8 6 5 3

♦ K Q

♣ 8 7

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	3 ♠ ¹
Pass	4 ♣ ²	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♠ ³	Pass	6 ♥
All Pass			

1. control

2. control

3. 2 keycards + trump Q

Lead: ♦ 7

How do you open the bidding? With 18 HCP and a balanced hand, you open 1 ♠. Partner responds 2 ♥. What do you rebid? You know this is a 5-card suit, and bid 3 ♥, confirming the 8+card trump fit and sets the trump suit. Partner rebids 3 ♠, a control bid, showing first or second round control. (Some will play this as showing 3-card support for spades, but I recommend playing this as a control bid.). You bid 4C, also a control bid, showing first or second round control in clubs. Partner bids 4NT, a keycard request using 1430.

You bid 5 ♠, showing two keycards and the trump queen. Partner bids the slam. The slam is a good one. If either the ♠Q or ♣K is right there are 12 tricks by way of a finesse. But the best way to play the hand would be to try to establish a ♠ in the North hand, and if that fails try the ♣ finesse.